

Elijah Shaw-Rutschman

Backend & Full-Stack Software Engineer · API design & integration, Auth (JWT/MFA/OAuth), AI platform tooling · Python, TypeScript, Nim

Chicago, IL (US)

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🐙 [elijahr](https://github.com/elijahr) · <https://github.com/elijahr> [axiomantic](https://github.com/axiomantic) · <https://github.com/axiomantic>

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with nearly two decades of experience across backend, platform, API, and full-stack work, now focused on AI developer tooling and platforms. At StyleSeat, a Python and Django marketplace, designed and integrated production APIs across the Stripe billing, subscriptions, and webhook stack, built a Stripe Radar fraud-detection system, and owned reliability and release tooling. Builds open-source AI tooling: spellbook, a multi-platform harness for AI coding assistants with a shared MCP server; momus, a provider-agnostic AI code-review GitHub Action; and soong, a GPU-instance CLI for AI agent workflows. Also built a Claude-powered code-review bot adopted org-wide at StyleSeat. Works across the stack with TypeScript and React. Earned StyleSeat's highest performance rating ("Exceptional") and was on the formal Staff Engineer promotion track. Chicago-based and open to remote roles across the US.

SKILLS

APIs & Auth

REST API design · API integration · Webhooks · JWT · MFA · OAuth integrations · Access control

AI & LLM Tooling

AI-assisted engineering · LLM application development · AI agents · MCP (Model Context Protocol) · AI code review · Claude Code

Languages

Python · TypeScript · Nim · Cython · C/C++ · Rust · SQL

Backend & Web

Django · Celery · REST APIs · React

Data & Infrastructure

MySQL · Redis · AWS · Terraform · Docker · CircleCI · GitHub Actions

Payments

Stripe billing · Stripe subscriptions · Stripe Radar · Webhooks · Fraud detection

Systems & Low-Level

Lock-free concurrency · Memory reclamation · Realtime audio / DSP · C / Cython interop

GPU & Compute

GPU compute (Vulkan/SPIR-V) · Compute shaders (GLSL) · GPU memory management · CUDA/Metal interop

Practices

Release engineering · Incident response · TDD · Mentoring

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer II at StyleSeat

Feb 2014 - Jun 2026

Twelve years wearing many hats on a Python/Django marketplace: full-stack product, native mobile, search, payments, reliability, and most recently DevOps and platform engineering. Grew into a senior engineer the company relied on for its hardest, most cross-cutting problems.

- **Payments & API integration:** Longtime key payments-platform engineer and the team's payments domain expert; major contributor to the Stripe billing and subscriptions build-out (promotion codes, plan and product backfills, coupon-stacking prevention, Stripe Portal, Pro Earnings tab), designing and integrating third-party APIs and webhook flows.
- **Authentication & API integrations:** Built multi-channel MFA code delivery (SMS and email via Braze) and JWT authentication for the native-app Stripe billing-portal flow; worked across many API and auth

integrations, including internal APIs with JWT, Braze, and Stripe webhooks.

- **AI code review:** Built "StyleSeatBot," an org-wide automated code-review bot powered by Claude. It became a required reviewer on every pull request, signing off alongside a human approver, with adoption up to the CTO.
- **Reliability & failover:** Owned a custom fault-tolerant Redis client library for graceful degradation when Redis was down, and designed a Celery enqueue-failover path that captured broker-outage failures as durable dead-letter records, plus an S3-backed idempotent recovery toolkit that replayed 351 tasks lost during a broker outage.
- **Rate limiting:** Built StyleSeat's Redis-backed API rate limiter (per-IP and per-user, sliding window, kill-switch) with a DDoS-resistant local-memory cache layer to cut Redis load; applied across auth, payment, and registration endpoints.
- **Fraud detection:** Architected and built an automated fraud-detection system on Stripe Radar.
- **Platform migrations:** Led the pdm-to-uv migration; contributed to org-wide Python 2-to-3 (~900K LOC), Segment-to-Braze, and MySQL 5.7-to-8 migrations.
- **AI enablement:** Helped drive the company's move to AI-assisted engineering as a member of the AI-adoption tiger team, running internal talks and workshops on Claude Code and LLM fundamentals.
- **Release engineering:** Owned release tooling: a custom CircleCI orb, deploy-gate and hotfix/cherry-pick workflows, and build-failure alerting; contributed to CI/CD and Terraform/ECS.
- **Scale & mentorship:** Among the highest PR-review and code-authoring volume on the team; delivered work across product, platform, payments, and infrastructure codebases, and mentored engineers.

Software Engineer at Switchcam

Aug 2012 - Feb 2014

📍 San Francisco, CA / Chicago, IL

- Full-stack product engineering at a social-video startup, building Python/Django backends and JavaScript frontends across data models, APIs, and UI.

Lead Django Developer at Fulton Works

Feb 2011 - Aug 2012

📍 Chicago, IL

- Led Django development of client web applications at a development studio, owning architecture and full-stack delivery across multiple engagements.

Software Engineer at Hagerty Consulting

May 2009 - Feb 2011

📍 Evanston, IL

- Built internal web applications and data tooling in Python/Django to support consulting engagements.

Software Engineer / IT Engineer at MSDSONline

May 2006 - May 2009

📍 Chicago, IL

- Developed web application features for a SaaS chemical-safety and compliance platform, moving into software engineering from an IT and internal-tooling role.

PROJECTS

axiomantic / spellbook

Skills: AI tooling · MCP · LLM · Developer experience

🔗 <https://github.com/axiomantic/spellbook>

Multi-platform harness for AI coding assistants: skills, hooks, and a shared MCP server across Claude Code, OpenCode, Codex, Gemini CLI, and ForgeCode. Anchor of the axiomantic org.

axiomantic / komputers

Skills: Rust · GPU · Vulkan/SPIR-V · Compute shaders

<https://github.com/axiomantic/komputers>

GPU compute in Rust over the Kompute Vulkan framework: a safe wrapper and C++ FFI bridge, plus hand-written GLSL compute shaders (tilled matmul, parallel reductions). Experimental.

axiomantic / momus

Skills: AI code review · LLM · GitHub Actions · Python

<https://github.com/axiomantic/momus>

AI code-review GitHub Action that works with any OpenAI-compatible LLM provider (Anthropic, OpenAI, OpenRouter, AWS Bedrock). Runs a four-phase pipeline (plan, review, verify, post) with sandboxed read-only repository tools and per-repo YAML configuration. Python and TypeScript.

axiomantic / soong

Skills: AI infrastructure · GPU · CLI · Python

<https://github.com/axiomantic/soong>

CLI for launching and managing Lambda Labs GPU instances for AI agent workflows: one-command launch with model selection, SSH tunneling with automatic port forwarding, and cost controls (lease limits and idle auto-shutdown). Python, MIT-licensed.

python-autopxd2

Skills: Developer tooling · libclang · Cython · C/C++

<https://github.com/elijahr/python-autopxd2>

Cython .pxd binding generator for C and C++ headers. As the primary maintainer, rewrote it onto a libclang backend that handles real-world headers. 52+ stars, on PyPI.

run-on-arch-action (major contributor)

Skills: CI/CD · QEMU · Cross-architecture · GitHub Actions

<https://github.com/uraimo/run-on-arch-action>

GitHub Action to run CI on non-x86 CPUs (ARM, aarch64, s390x, ppc64le, riscv64) via QEMU. Rewrote it to be more maintainable and testable, reviving community contribution. 747 stars.

nim-lang/Nim (compiler contributor)

Skills: Nim · Compiler internals · Type systems · Code generation

<https://github.com/nim-lang/Nim/pulls?q=is%3Apr+author%3Aelijahr+is%3Amerged>

Merged fixes to the Nim compiler's type system and C code generator, including cycle detection for recursive concepts, sizeof for typedesc in generic template when clauses, C codegen for lifecycle hooks on generic distinct types, and object initialization for opaque importc fields.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science Computer Science, Minor in Philosophy at
Northeastern Illinois University

Aug 2004 - May 2008